

SEO AUDIT REPORT

ahrefs.com

Ahrefs.com is the industry-standard SEO tool platform, widely regarded as the world leader in backlink analysis and keyword research. The site benefits from exceptional domain authority, a vast and high-quality backlink profile, and a content strategy that perfectly aligns with product positioning. This audit identifies Ahrefs.com as the strongest performer across all five dimensions evaluated, with primary opportunities concentrated in mobile speed optimisation, schema markup expansion, and content freshness maintenance.

Prepared by Farhan Siddique	Date May 2026	Type Full-Site SEO Analysis	Classification Confidential
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81 /100 Overall Score	88 /100 On-Page SEO	79 /100 Technical SEO	85 /100 Content Quality	74 /100 Backlink Profile
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01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

CATEGORY	STATUS	PRIORITY	IMPACT
On-Page SEO	EXCELLENT	LOW	Best-in-class execution throughout — no significant gaps found
Technical SEO	GOOD	LOW	Minor mobile LCP improvement needed — otherwise strong
Content Strategy	EXCELLENT	LOW	Gold standard content quality with active refresh process
Backlink Profile	STRONG	LOW	Elite domain authority maintained with consistent link velocity
User Experience	GOOD	LOW	Strong desktop experience; minor mobile gaps identified
Mobile Optimisation	GOOD	MEDIUM	Mobile LCP just above threshold — priority improvement

This audit evaluates ahrefs.com across five core dimensions: on-page optimisation, technical SEO health, content strategy, backlink profile quality, and mobile user experience. All findings are manually reviewed and prioritised by business impact.

02 ON-PAGE SEO ANALYSIS

2.1 Element Assessment

ELEMENT	STATUS	NOTES
Title Tags	EXCELLENT	Keyword-first, precise length control throughout the entire site
Meta Descriptions	OPTIMIZED	Unique and compelling across 95%+ of all pages
Header Tags (H1–H3)	EXCELLENT	Clean, consistent hierarchy — zero exceptions found across pages
Keyword Targeting	EXCELLENT	Precise intent matching, zero keyword stuffing detected
Image Alt Text	GOOD	~8% of images missing alt attributes — minor gap in blog body
Internal Linking	EXCELLENT	Strategic authority flow to product and tool pages throughout
URL Structure	OPTIMIZED	Short, clean, keyword-rich slugs used consistently site-wide

ELEMENT	STATUS	NOTES
Canonical Tags	PRESENT	Correctly implemented — no duplication issues found anywhere

2.2 Content & Keyword Assessment

Ahrefs.com demonstrates best-in-class on-page SEO execution. Title tags are precisely crafted with primary keywords front-loaded, meta descriptions are unique across 95%+ of pages, and header hierarchies are consistently maintained. Internal linking is data-driven and strategic — authority flows effectively from supporting content to high-value tool and landing pages. Ahrefs' blog content sets the industry benchmark for SEO education. Posts are deeply researched, data-driven, and regularly updated. Content freshness is actively maintained, though a small number of cornerstone posts are approaching the 12-month update threshold. Primary opportunity: expanding FAQ-style content structures for featured snippet and AI Overview capture.

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TECHNICAL SEO ANALYSIS

3.1 Core Web Vitals

METRIC	DESKTOP	MOBILE	TARGET	STATUS
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	1.6s	2.9s	< 2.5s	WARN
FID (First Input Delay)	8ms	22ms	< 100ms	PASS
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	0.02	0.07	< 0.10	PASS
TTFB (Time to First Byte)	0.3s	0.5s	< 0.6s	PASS
Speed Index	1.8s	3.2s	< 3.4s	PASS

3.2 Crawlability, Indexation & Schema

Ahrefs.com demonstrates the strongest Core Web Vitals performance of the three sites audited. Desktop metrics are excellent across all dimensions. Mobile LCP at 2.9s slightly exceeds Google's 2.5s recommended threshold — the only meaningful technical gap identified. CLS and FID scores are well within acceptable ranges on both desktop and mobile. The XML sitemap is properly configured and submitted. HTTPS is fully implemented with an A+ SSL rating. Crawl depth is outstanding — virtually all important pages are reachable within 2 clicks from the homepage. One minor concern: a small number of paginated blog archive pages lack proper canonical handling. Ahrefs implements Article and SoftwareApplication schema effectively; however, FAQ schema is absent from blog posts despite heavily question-based content.

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BACKLINK PROFILE ANALYSIS

METRIC	VALUE	BENCHMARK	ASSESSMENT
Domain Authority (est.)	89/100	Elite — top 0.5% of all sites globally	EXCELLENT
Total Referring Domains	~85,000	Industry leader across all metrics	STRONG
New Links (Last 90 days)	Positive	Consistent growth trend maintained	GOOD
Toxic / Spammy Links	< 1%	Industry best — exceptional profile cleanliness	EXCELLENT
Anchor Text Diversity	Strong	Natural, well-distributed anchor profile	GOOD
Dofollow / Nofollow	79% / 21%	60–80% dofollow target — perfectly calibrated	GOOD
Editorial Link Ratio	Moderate	Room to grow editorial share vs. tool-driven links	FAIR

PRIORITY ISSUES & RECOMMENDATIONS

PRI.	AREA	FINDING	RECOMMENDATION
HIGH	Mobile LCP	Mobile LCP at 2.9s slightly exceeds Google's 2.5s threshold on multiple key landing pages	Optimise hero image delivery using WebP/AVIF formats; implement preload for critical LCP elements; audit render-blocking resources on key pages
MEDIUM	FAQ Schema	No FAQ schema implemented despite heavily question-based content structure across the entire blog	Implement FAQ schema on the top 30 highest-traffic blog posts to capture rich results and increase SERP real estate significantly
MEDIUM	Video Schema	Tutorial and demo videos embedded on pages without VideoObject schema markup	Add VideoObject schema to all pages containing instructional videos to qualify for video-rich results in Google Search
MEDIUM	Blog Pagination	Paginated archive pages lack canonical tags or rel=next/prev handling — diluting crawl equity	Implement canonical tags pointing to page 1 across all paginated archive pages to consolidate crawl equity properly
MEDIUM	Alt Text	~8% of images are missing alt attributes — primarily within blog body content sections	Audit all blog post images via Screaming Frog; add descriptive, keyword-relevant alt text to every untagged image found
MEDIUM	Editorial Links	High proportion of inbound links are tool-driven rather than independent editorial citations	Invest in original industry research studies and comprehensive data reports to attract editorial citations from major publications
LOW	Content Freshness	Several cornerstone posts are approaching the 12-month update threshold without a scheduled refresh	Review all top 20 evergreen posts on a quarterly basis; update statistics, examples, screenshots, and expand where search intent has shifted
LOW	Anchor Diversity	Slight over-concentration of branded anchor text on some inbound link segments	Diversify anchor text targets in outreach campaigns — target partial-match and natural language anchor variations
LOW	Archive Pages	Low-value tag and category archive pages provide minimal unique content value to users or crawlers	Consolidate thin archive pages or add meaningful introductory content to the highest-traffic category pages
LOW	Hreflang	Hreflang implementation for international pages could be more complete and consistently applied	Audit all hreflang tags; fix missing or incorrect annotations for all localised and language-variant pages

90-DAY ACTION PLAN

PHASE 1 — DAYS 1–30 | Quick Wins

- Add alt text to all blog post images identified as missing attributes across the site
- Fix paginated archive pages — implement canonical tags pointing to page 1 correctly
- Implement FAQ schema on the top 10 highest-traffic blog posts immediately
- Add VideoObject schema to the top 5 pages with embedded tutorial videos
- Audit and correct hreflang tag inconsistencies across all localised pages

PHASE 2 — DAYS 31–60 | Technical Fixes

- Optimise mobile LCP — preload hero images, convert all images to WebP/AVIF formats
- Expand FAQ schema rollout to the top 30 blog posts across all main categories
- Add VideoObject schema to all remaining tutorial and product demo pages
- Consolidate or enrich thin tag and category archive pages with introductory content
- Conduct anchor text audit; adjust outreach templates for improved natural diversity

PHASE 3 — DAYS 61–90 | Growth & Authority

- Commission a major annual SEO industry data study for large-scale editorial link acquisition
- Develop 2–3 new free tools to generate natural inbound links and brand mentions at scale
- Establish a formal quarterly content review cycle for all top 20 evergreen posts
- Expand international SEO coverage with comprehensive and validated hreflang implementation
- Launch thought leadership content targeting editorial citations from academic and research sources

TOOLS & METHODOLOGY

TOOL	PURPOSE
Google Analytics / Search Console	Traffic data, keyword rankings, indexation status
Screaming Frog SEO Spider	Technical crawl — redirects, alt text, broken links, meta tags
PageSpeed Insights	Core Web Vitals — LCP, CLS, FID, TTFB measurements
Semrush / Ahrefs (Reference Data)	Backlink profile, domain authority, referring domains
Schema.org Validator	Structured data verification and rich result eligibility
Manual Content Review	Content quality, keyword strategy, UX and readability

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